In this section, you'll see how to create your first migration and use it to create a database. Then you'll update your data model, create a second migration, and use it to update the database schema.

12.3.1 Creating your first migration

Before you can create migrations, you need to install the necessary tooling. You have two primary ways to do this:

- *Package manager console*—You can use PowerShell cmdlets inside Visual Studio's Package Manager Console (PMC). You can install them directly from the PMC or by adding the Microsoft.EntityFrameworkCore.Tools package to your project.
- *.NET tool*—You can use cross-platform, command-line tooling that extends the .NET SDK. You can install the EF Core .NET tool globally for your machine by running `dotnet tool install --global dotnet-ef`.

In this book I use the cross-platform .NET tools, but if you're familiar with EF 6.x or prefer to use the Visual Studio PMC, there are equivalent commands for the steps you're going to take (http://mng.bz/9DK7). You can check that the .NET tool installed correctly by running `dotnet ef`, which should produce a help screen like the one shown in figure 12.6.